

Lycaon pictus

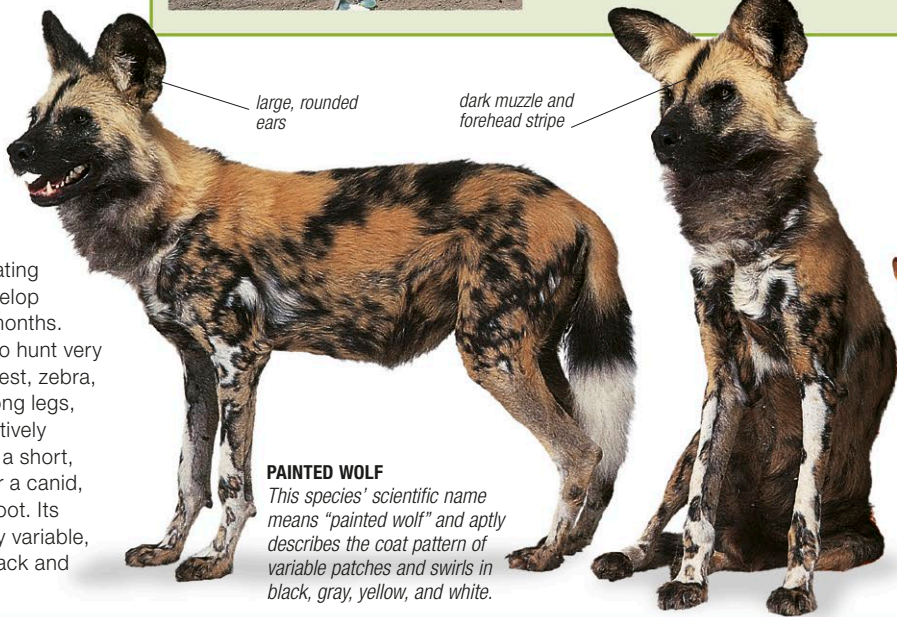
African wild dog



Length 30–43 in
(76–141 cm)
Tail 12–16 in
(30–40 cm)
Weight 37–79 lb
(17–36 kg)
Location Australia
Social unit Group
Status Endangered



Probably the most social canid, the African wild or hunting dog lives in packs of 30 or more adults and young. Only the dominant pair breed, producing a litter of 10–12 (range 2–21) after a gestation of 71–73 days. However, the whole pack cares for and protects the pups, regurgitating food for them until they develop hunting skills by about 12 months. The pack also cooperates to hunt very large prey, such as wildebeest, zebra, and impala. This dog has long legs, and a lean build, with a relatively small head, large ears, and a short, broad muzzle. Unusually for a canid, it has only 4 toes on each foot. Its coat pattern is exceptionally variable, but the muzzle is usually black and the tail tip is white.



PAINTED WOLF
This species' scientific name means "painted wolf" and aptly describes the coat pattern of variable patches and swirls in black, gray, yellow, and white.

CONSERVATION



Once widespread across Africa, in many habitats, this wild dog is now reduced to scattered, fragmented populations. It is still persecuted, trapped, shot, and snared, and is also killed accidentally by road vehicles. It suffers both habitat loss and diseases (rabies, distemper) from domestic dogs. Survival depends on active conservation, including tracking pack movements by fitting with radio collars (shown here).

Otocyon megalotis

Bat-eared fox



Length 18–24 in
(46–61 cm)
Tail 10¾–13½ in
(27.5–34 cm)
Weight 6½–12 lb
(3.2–5.4 kg)
Location E. and southern Africa
Social unit Variable
Status Least concern



Huge ears and a small face with a pointed muzzle are the bat-eared fox's main external features, but its teeth, too, are very unusual. They are much smaller than those of a typical canid, and with up to 8 extra molars may number 48—more than any other nonmarsupial mammal. Its main diet is insects, especially termites and dung beetles. However, the breeding and social habits of this species are more typically foxlike.



Cuon alpinus

Dhole



Length 3–4½ ft
(0.9–1.4 m)
Tail 12½–20 in
(32–50 cm)
Weight 22–44 lb
(10–20 kg)
Location S., E., and S.E. Asia
Social unit Group
Status Endangered



Also called the Asian red dog, the dhole species is widespread, but with a shrinking overall range and declining numbers. It lives in territorial, day-active packs of up to 25 individuals, including pups, that are usually based on an extended family. The fur color is evenly tawny or dark red, with a darker tail and lighter underparts; the legs are relatively short. The main prey is medium-sized hoofed mammals, supplemented by smaller creatures, fruit, and other plant food.



Canis lupus dingo

Dingo



Length 28¾–43 in
(72–110 cm)
Tail 8½–14 in
(21–36 cm)
Weight 20–47 lb
(9–21.5 kg)
Location Africa
Social unit Group
Status Vulnerable



This dog has variously been regarded as a subspecies of the domestic dog; as a subspecies of the domestic dog's ancestor, the gray wolf (see p.174); or as a full and separate species in its own right. Recent studies indicate that the dingo should be treated as a subspecies of the gray wolf, rather than as a descendant of feral domestic dogs. Dingoes are found throughout Australia, except for the southwest and southeast, where dingo fences exclude them from livestock; they are classified as pests, both to farm animals and for rabies control. Dingolike dogs also occur wild, semiferal, or semidomesticated, on the mainland and many islands of South and Southeast Asia. Dingoes interbreed readily with domestic dogs, and in parts of Australia one-third of individuals are such hybrids. Prey includes

rabbits, rodents, wallabies, small kangaroos, and birds. However, the opportunistic dingo can survive on fruit, plant matter, and carrion. In social behavior and pack system, it resembles the gray wolf.



irregular white patches on muzzle, chest, belly, and feet

bushy tail may be white-tipped

PACK HIERARCHY



Young male dingoes may be solitary and nomadic. Breeding adults usually form settled packs, unless the population is widely spaced, when pairs are likely. About 5 pups (range 1–10) are born after a gestation of 63 days. Senior pack members teach them their place in the hierarchy by nips and other rebuffs.

DINGO OR DOG?

The dingo's coat varies from light sandy to deep red-tinger. Dingo-domestic dog hybrids can look very similar, but may be distinguished by their canine and carnassial tooth shape.